

Project Specification: Employee Onboarding System

1. Context & Objective

You are working in a rapidly growing company where the need is to automate the historically chaotic, manual steps of bringing a new hire onto the team. As a developer on the internal tools team, your objective is to build a full-stack web application that manages the complete lifecycle of an Employee Onboarding process, ensuring HR, IT, and Management are perfectly synced.

While this document outlines the minimum core requirements, you are free to add any other functionality you feel would improve the user experience or make the system more robust.

2. Technology Stack

While you are free to design the exact architecture, you are highly encouraged to use the following recommended tech stack:

- **Database:** PostgreSQL (Relational database to persist data).
- **Frontend UI:** Next.js (React framework for the client-side interface).
- **Backend:** You may choose one of the following for your server-side application to handle business logic and APIs: NestJS, Python, Java

3. Core Business Process

The application must support the onboarding lifecycle of a new employee through the following stages. Pay close attention to the conditional routing and rejection paths:

1. **Initiation:** HR submits a new employee profile, which must include the hire's name, role, start date, and a requested hardware tier (e.g., "Standard", "Premium").
2. **Manager Review:** The Hiring Manager reviews the profile and approves the system-generated "Fișa de post" (Job Description/Role Specification).
3. **Finance Approval (Conditional):** If the requested hardware tier is "Premium", the request must route to a Finance Representative to approve the hardware budget. If the tier is "Standard", this step is bypassed entirely.
4. **IT Provisioning:** An IT representative receives the approved profile, generates the company email/account credentials, and confirms the laptop configuration.

5. **Completion:** The onboarding ticket is marked as completed once all departments have finalized their tasks.
6. **The Rejection Loop:** At any approval stage (Manager, Finance, or IT), the reviewer must have the option to *Reject* the onboarding request (e.g., incorrect title, unrealistic start date). If rejected, the status changes to "Needs Rework" and it is sent back to HR. HR can then edit the details and resubmit it, which restarts the workflow.